

WORLD CUP 2026



THE ULTIMATE SOUVENIR GUIDEBOOK

WORLD CUP HISTORY & LEGENDS

1930
URUGUAY

1954
SWITZERLAND

1970
BRAZIL

1998
FRANCE





#1 MetLife Stadium • The Silver Giant

■ New York / NJ

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■ NYC — Statue of Liberty, 800+ languages, Broadway, Times Sq
- ■■ 82,500 seats, 40K tons steel, hosts 2026 World Cup Final
- ■ Meadowlands sports complex — home to Giants + Jets
- ■ Silver louvers change color for each team playing
- ■ World Cup Final — eyes of the world on this stadium!
- ■ Built with 40,000 tons of steel = 8,000 elephants!
- ■ Stadium glows team colors at night — stunning view
- ■ The Meadowlands — 750 acres of sports + entertainment
- ■ NYC pizza capital — 1,600+ pizzerias across the city
- ■ 13,000+ yellow cabs — iconic NYC street scene
- ■ Broadway — 41 theaters with 12 million annual fans
- ■ Times Square — 330,000 people walk through daily



■ Player Profile

Christian Pulisic • USA

Forward • AC Milan

7 ■ Caps	29 ■ Goals	Forward ■ Position	Milan ■ Club
-------------	---------------	-----------------------	-----------------

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Christian Pulisic — 'Captain America'
- ■■ 69 caps, 29 goals for USMNT
- ■ Forward for AC Milan / Chelsea
- ■ Youngest USMNT captain ever (age 20)
- ■ First American to play in UCL final
- ■ Explosive speed + dribbling skills
- ■ 3x US Soccer Player of the Year
- ■ Born in Hershey, Pennsylvania
- ■ Scored in 2022 World Cup vs Iran
- ■■ Started pro career at Dortmund age 16
- ■ Most capped US player under 25
- ■ Key player for USMNT since 2016



#2 Lincoln Financial Field • The Linc

■ Philadelphia, PA

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: Philly — Liberty Bell (famous crack!), Cheesesteaks
- ■■ Stadium: 69,176 seats, 11K solar panels, net-zero energy
- ■■ First US capital 1790 — Independence Hall, Rocky Steps
- ■ 14 wind turbines + LEED Gold — one of greenest stadiums!
- ■ 'Eagle Wings' architecture — iconic Philly skyline
- ■ Fun Fact: The Linc hosted Pope Francis mass in 2015!
- ■ Home to Eagles — one of NFL's loudest stadiums
- ■ 11,000 solar panels = enough to power 1,000 homes
- ■ Philly is famous for Soft Pretzels and 'Water Ice'
- ■ Hosted the first-ever Army-Navy game in 1890
- ■ Philly has more outdoor murals than any other city!
- ■ The Avenue of the Arts — heart of Philly's theater scene



■ Player Profile

Vinícius Júnior • Brazil

Forward • Real Madrid

30

■ Caps

5

■ Goals

Forward

■ Position

Madrid

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Vinícius Júnior — 'Vini'
- ■■ 30 caps, 5 goals for Brazil
- ■ Forward for Real Madrid
- ■ Won Copa América 2019 + UCL 2022
- ■ Scored winning goal in UCL final!
- ■ Samba dribbling — one of world's best
- ■ Joined Real Madrid at 18 for €45M
- ■ Born in São Gonçalo, Brazil
- ■ Wears #7 — the legendary Real Madrid jersey number
- ■ Started playing futsal before moving to the grass pitch
- ■■ Runs a charity to help improve education in Brazil
- ■ Scored in two different Champions League finals!



#3 FedExField • The FedEx Giant

■ Landover, MD (DC)

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: DC — White House, Lincoln Memorial, Smithsonian (free!)
- ■■ Stadium: 82,000 seats, near Capitol Hill, huge footprint
- ■ Cherry blossoms — 3,000 trees gifted from Japan
- ■ National Mall — 2 miles of American history
- ■ Hosted Rolling Stones, Beyoncé, and major concerts
- ■ Fun Fact: 30,000+ parking spaces — one of NFL's biggest!
- ■ Near Washington Monument — 555 ft tall obelisk
- ■ 19 Smithsonian museums — all free admission
- ■■ D.C. has no skyscrapers — buildings can't be too tall!
- ■ Rock Creek Park is 2x larger than NYC's Central Park
- ■ Library of Congress — the largest library in the world
- ■■ Sculpture Garden — features an ice rink in the winter



■ Player Profile

Harry Kane • England

Striker • Bayern Munich

91 ■ Caps	62 ■ Goals	Striker ■ Position	Munich ■ Club
--------------	---------------	-----------------------	------------------

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Harry Kane — England captain
- ■■■■■■ 91 caps, 62 goals (all-time top scorer)
- ■ Striker for Bayern Munich
- ■ Golden Boot — 2018 World Cup (6 goals)
- ■ 3x Premier League Golden Boot winner
- ■ Deadly penalty accuracy — 90%+ conversion
- ■ Scored on Premier League debut at 18
- ■ Born in London, England
- ■ Has won the Premier League Golden Boot 3 times
- ■ Loves his two Labradors, Brady and Wilson
- ■ Scored against every Premier League opponent he faced
- ■ Awarded an MBE by the Queen for services to soccer



#4 Hard Rock Stadium • Hard Rock Hero

■ Miami Gardens, FL

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: Miami — South Beach, Art Deco, Cuban coffee, 248 sun days
- ■■ Stadium: 65,326 seats, canopy covers 90%, F1 Grand Prix
- ■ Art Deco District — 960+ colorful buildings
- ■ Port of Miami — #1 cruise port in the world
- ■ Latin music capital — salsa, reggaeton, and more
- ■ Fun Fact: Hosts Miami Grand Prix — F1 cars race around it!
- ■ Open-air tropical vibe — corner spires like ship masts
- ■ \$500M renovation in 2016 transformed the stadium
- ■■ Miami: only place where gators and crocodiles coexist!
- ■ Wynwood Walls — world's largest open-air street art
- ■ Miami has the 3rd tallest skyline in the United States
- ■ Bordered by two National Parks — Everglades & Biscayne



■ Player Profile

Lionel Messi • Argentina

Forward • Inter Miami CF

180

■ Caps

106

■ Goals

Forward

■ Position

CF

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Lionel Messi — The GOAT
- ■■ 180 caps, 106 goals for Argentina
- ■ Forward for Inter Miami CF
- ■ 8x Ballon d'Or winner — most ever!
- ■ Won 2022 World Cup with Argentina
- ■ 800+ career goals — legendary scorer
- ■ 91 goals in 2012 — world record!
- ■ Born in Rosario, Argentina
- ■■ Won 44 team trophies — most by any player in history!
- ■ Overcame a growth hormone deficiency as a child
- ■ Favorite food: Milanesa a la Napolitana (Argentine steak)
- 🍷 ■ Signed first Barcelona contract on a paper napkin!



#5 Mercedes-Benz Stadium • The Benz

■ Atlanta, GA

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: Atlanta — world's busiest airport, Southern hospitality
- ■■ Stadium: 71K+ seats, roof opens like flower in 8 min
- ■ Georgia Aquarium — largest in US (6.3 million gallons)
- ■ Halo Board — 360° video screen, largest in NFL
- ■■ LEED Platinum — highest green building certification
- ■ Fun Fact: Fan-friendly pricing — \$2 hot dogs, \$5 beers!
- ■ Retractable roof — 8 'petals' that open in 8 minutes
- ■ Coca-Cola was invented in Atlanta in 1886
- ■ Georgia is the 'Peach State' but top crop is peanuts!
- ■ SkyView Atlanta — 20-story tall Ferris wheel
- ■ 'City in a Forest' — known for its massive tree canopy
- ■■ Stadium video board could fit a jumbo jet inside!



■ Player Profile

Kylian Mbappé • France

Forward • Real Madrid

75

■ Caps

46

■ Goals

Forward

■ Position

Madrid

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Kylian Mbappé — French phenom
- ■■ 75 caps, 46 goals for France
- ■ Forward for Real Madrid
- ■ World Cup winner at age 19 (2018)!
- ■ Hat-trick in 2022 World Cup final
- ■ Fastest player ever recorded on pitch
- ■ 6 Ligue 1 titles with PSG
- ■ Born in Bondy, France
- ■ Won the World Cup Golden Boot in 2022 (8 goals)
- ■ Top speed of 38 km/h — almost as fast as Usain Bolt!
- ■ Nicknamed 'Donatello' (Ninja Turtle) by teammates
- ■ Donated 2018 World Cup earnings to a children's charity



#6 NRG Stadium • NRG Neo

■ Houston, TX

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■ City: Houston — Space City! NASA Mission Control HQ
- ■■ Stadium: 72,220 seats, first retractable roof in US
- ■ Space Center Houston — see real rockets and astronaut training
- ■ Most diverse food scene in Texas — 70+ cuisines
- ■ Live music capital of the South
- ■ Fun Fact: First NFL stadium with a retractable roof!
- ■ Hosted Super Bowls XXXVIII + LI + 2017 World Series
- ■ Texas Medical Center — world's largest medical complex
- ■ Houston is the 'Energy Capital of the World'
- ■ The first traditional cheeseburger was created in Texas!
- ■■ Stadium hosts soccer, football, and even huge rodeos
- ■ 20 feet below the city is a 7-mile tunnel system!



■ Player Profile

Victor Osimhen • Nigeria

Striker • Galatasaray

35

■ Caps

21

■ Goals

Striker

■ Position

Galatasaray

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Victor Osimhen — Nigerian superstar
- ■■ 35 caps, 21 goals for Nigeria
- ■ Striker for Galatasaray
- ■ African Footballer of the Year 2023
- ■ 31 goals in Serie A 2022-23 season
- ■ Known for aerial ability + lightning speed
- ■ Led Napoli to first Serie A title in 33 years
- ■ Born in Lagos, Nigeria
- ■ Wears a protective black mask during every match
- ■ 3rd Nigerian to ever win African Footballer of the Year
- ■ Started career at 'Ultimate Strikers Academy' in Lagos
- ■ Highest-scoring African in Serie A history (2023)



#7 AT&T Stadium • Titan Tex

■ Arlington, TX (Dallas)

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■ City: Dallas — Texas BBQ, State Fair, Reunion Tower
- ■■ Stadium: 80K+ seats, 160-ft video board (size of a 737!)
- ■ Texas BBQ capital — brisket, ribs, and sausage
- ■ 3,000+ HD TVs throughout the concourse
- ■ World's largest retractable glass doors
- ■ Fun Fact: Video board is longer than a Boeing 737 airplane!
- ■ 'Jerry World' — named after Cowboys owner Jerry Jones
- ■ Can expand to 105,000 seats for big events
- ■ The Frozen Margarita machine was invented in Dallas!
- ■ Six Flags Over Texas — the first Six Flags theme park
- ■■ Stadium uses enough power to light up a small town!
- ■ Home to the tallest Ferris wheel in North America



■ Player Profile

Son Heung-min • South Korea

Forward • Tottenham

127

■ Caps

48

■ Goals

Forward

■ Position

Tottenham

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Son Heung-min — Asia's biggest star
- ■■ 127 caps, 48 goals for South Korea
- ■ Forward for Tottenham Hotspur
- ■ Premier League Golden Boot 2021-22
- ■ First Asian to win PL Golden Boot ever!
- ■ Puskás Award — 70m solo run goal 2019
- ■ Captain of South Korea since 2022
- ■ Born in Chuncheon, South Korea
- ■■ His father was also a pro soccer player and coach
- ■ Known for his iconic 'camera' goal celebration
- ■■ Completed military service in South Korea in 2020
- ■ Loves playing the piano and video games for fun



#8 SoFi Stadium • The Infinity Giant

■ Inglewood, CA (LA)

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■ City: LA — Hollywood Sign, Venice Beach, Walk of Fame, studios
- ■■ Stadium: 70K+ seats, \$5.5B — most expensive stadium ever!
- ■■ Only double-sided 4K video board in the world
- ■ Indoor-outdoor design — ocean breeze flows through
- ■ Hosted Super Bowl LVI + will host 2028 Olympics
- ■ Fun Fact: \$5.5 billion — most expensive sports venue ever!
- ■ 3 million square feet — one of largest stadiums globally
- ■ Located in Hollywood Park — 298 acres of entertainment
- ■ Hollywood sign originally said 'HOLLYWOODLAND'
- ■ L.A. is the birthplace of the Hot Fudge Sundae!
- ■■ Stadium roof is held up by 37 earthquake-proof pillars
- ■ Griffith Park — home to the famous L.A. Observatory



■ Player Profile

Cristiano Ronaldo • Portugal

Forward • Al Nassr

205

■ Caps

128

■ Goals

Forward

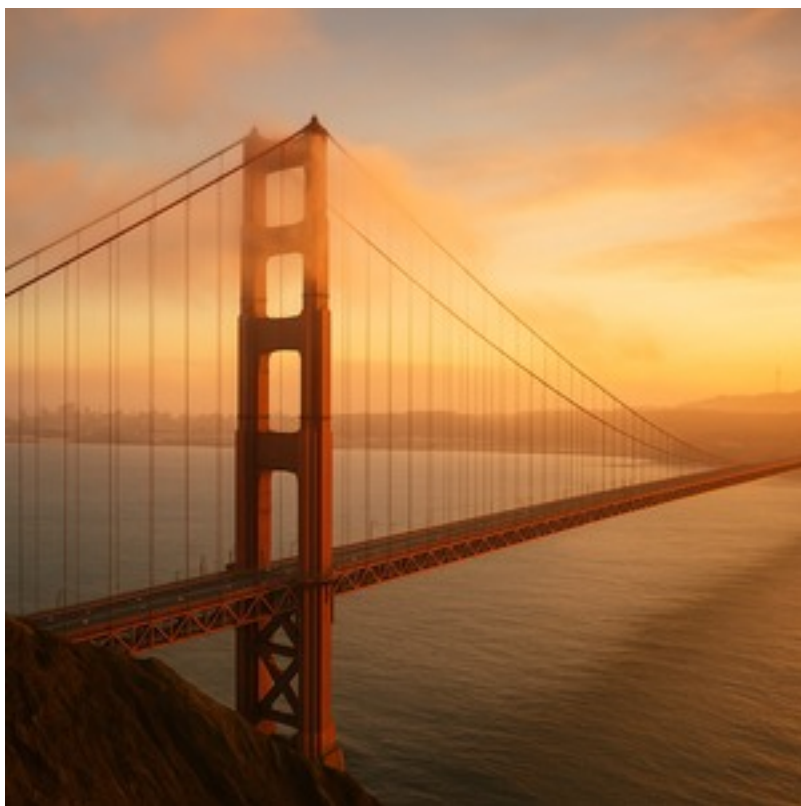
■ Position

Nassr

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Cristiano Ronaldo — CR7 legend
- ■■ 205 caps, 128 goals (all-time top scorer!)
- ■ Forward for Al Nassr FC
- ■ 5x Ballon d'Or winner
- ■ Won Euro 2016 with Portugal
- ■ 900+ career goals — one of greatest ever
- ■ All-time international top scorer in history
- ■ Born in Funchal, Madeira, Portugal
- ■■ Famous for his strict diet and 5-6 small meals a day
- ■ Has no tattoos so he can donate blood regularly
- ■ Won the Champions League 5 times with two clubs
- ■■ Has an international airport named after him!



#9 Levi's Stadium • The Silicon Giant

■ Santa Clara, CA (Bay Area)

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■ City: SF Bay — Golden Gate Bridge (1.7 miles), Silicon Valley
- ■■ Stadium: 68,500 seats, net-zero energy, solar parking
- ■ Cable cars — iconic San Francisco transport since 1873
- ■■■ Faithful Farm — rooftop garden grows veggies for games!
- ■ Silicon Valley — tech capital of the world
- ■ Fun Fact: Roof garden grows tomatoes, peppers, herbs for food!
- ■ Super Bowl 50 was hosted here in 2016
- ■ Fog rolls in — 'Karl the Fog' is a local celebrity
- ■ Golden Gate color is officially 'International Orange'
- ■ Fortune cookies were invented in San Francisco!
- ■■ First U.S. stadium to be LEED Gold certified
- ■ S.F. Zoo — home to the first U.S. born koalas



■ Player Profile

Bernardo Silva • Portugal

Midfielder • Manchester City

93

■ Caps

12

■ Goals

Midfielder

■ Position

City

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Bernardo Silva — midfield maestro
- ■■ 93 caps, 12 goals for Portugal
- ■ Midfielder for Manchester City
- ■ 4x Premier League champion
- ■ Won Champions League with Man City 2023
- ■ Known for incredible ball control + passing
- ■ UEFA Nations League winner 2019
- ■ Born in Lisbon, Portugal
- ■ Huge fan of Roger Federer and loves playing tennis
- ■ Named his French bulldog 'John' after a teammate
- ■■ Called 'Bubblegum' because the ball sticks to him
- ■ Won a 'treble' (3 major trophies) with Man City 2023



#10 Lumen Field • The Roaring Giant

■ Seattle, WA

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: Seattle — Space Needle (605 ft), coffee capital
- ■■ Stadium: 69,000 seats — LOUDEST stadium in the world!
- ■ Starbucks was born in Seattle at Pike Place Market 1971
- ■ Pacific Northwest — stunning forests, mountains, water
- ■ Grunge music birthplace — Nirvana, Pearl Jam, Soundgarden
- ■ Fun Fact: Fans caused measured earthquakes when cheering!
- ■ Horseshoe shape focuses sound like a giant megaphone
- ■ Pike Place Market — famous flying fish since 1907
- ■ Seattleites drink more coffee than any other U.S. city
- ■ Seattle Great Wheel — one of the largest in the West
- ■ Smith Tower — once the tallest building in the West
- ■■ Take a ferry across Puget Sound to visit nearby islands



■ Player Profile

Virgil van Dijk • Netherlands

Defender • Liverpool

68

■ Caps

9

■ Goals

Defender

■ Position

Liverpool

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Virgil van Dijk — defensive wall
- ■■ 68 caps, 9 goals for Netherlands
- ■ Defender for Liverpool FC
- ■ UEFA Men's Player of the Year 2019
- ■ Won Champions League with Liverpool 2019
- ■ Known as one of best defenders in history
- ■ Captain of Netherlands national team
- ■ Born in Breda, Netherlands
- ■ Went 65 consecutive games without being dribbled past!
- ■ Worked as a dishwasher before becoming a pro player
- ■ First defender to be a Ballon d'Or finalist since 2006
- ■ Stands 6'4" tall — a giant of the defensive line



#11 Gillette Stadium • The Lighthouse Giant

■ Foxborough, MA (Boston)

■ CITY & STADIUM FACTS

- ■■ City: Boston — Freedom Trail (2.5 miles), Tea Party, Harvard
- ■■ Stadium: 65,878 seats, 22-story lighthouse — iconic beacon!
- ■ Famous for lobster rolls, clam chowder, and baked beans
- ■ Hosted 6 Super Bowls — one of NFL's legendary venues
- ■ Harvard (1636) + MIT — world's top universities
- ■ Fun Fact: 22-story lighthouse is a real working beacon!
- ■ Lighthouse + bridge entrance — like a New England postcard
- ■ Home to Patriots + Revolution — football + soccer
- ■ Boston's Swan Boats have been around since 1877
- ■ First U.S. subway system was built in Boston in 1897
- ■ Boston Cream Pie is actually a cake (State Dessert!)
- ■■ Stadium is surrounded by historic cranberry bogs



■ Player Profile

Gianluigi Donnarumma • Italy

Goalkeeper • Paris Saint-Germain

62

■ Caps

0

■ Goals

Goalkeeper

■ Position

Saint-Germain

■ Club

■ FUN FACTS

- ■ Gianluigi Donnarumma — giant in goal
- ■■ 62 caps, 0 goals (goalkeeper!)
- ■ Goalkeeper for Paris Saint-Germain
- ■ Euro 2020 Player of the Tournament!
- ■ Won Euro 2020 with Italy
- ■ Saved 2 penalties in Euro 2020 final shootout
- ■ Debut at AC Milan at age 16 — youngest ever
- ■ Born in Castellammare di Stabia, Italy
- ■ Made his pro debut for AC Milan at only 16 years old
- ■■ Replaced the legendary Buffon as Italy's #1 goalie
- ■ Named Player of the Tournament at Euro 2020
- ■ Stands 6'5" tall — a massive reach in the goal!

WORLD CUP

BY THE NUMBERS & TECH CORNER

48 104 3

TEAMS

MATCHES

HOST
COUNTRIES



GOAL-LINE
TECHNOLOGY

World Cup 2026 • By The Numbers

48 Nations
Most teams ever in a World Cup

104 Matches
Record-breaking games

16 Host Cities
Across USA, Mexico & Canada

11 Stadium Giants
Each with a unique personality

3 Countries
First tri-hosted World Cup ever

5 Billion Viewers
Estimated global TV audience

40,000 Tons Steel
Used in MetLife Stadium alone

11,000+ Solar Panels
Power Lincoln Financial Field

160 ft Video Board
AT&T Stadium massive screen

8 Min Roof Open
Mercedes-Benz halo roof opens

70,000+ Avg Capacity
Across all 11 stadiums

\$5.5B Stadium
SoFi most expensive ever built

A wide-angle photograph of a large football stadium at night. The stands are packed with fans, many of whom are waving Mexican flags (green, white, and red). The pitch is brightly lit by stadium lights, and several players are visible on the field. In the background, three large fireworks are exploding in the dark sky. The overall atmosphere is one of a major celebration or victory.

KEEP DREAMING.
KEEP PLAYING.
KEEP ROARING!